

provides a comparison of bitcoin versus three of the most important stock market indices: the S&P 500, the Dow Jones Industrial Average (DJIA), and the NASDAQ 100, respectively. It assumes a \$100 investment was made on July 19, 2010, a few days after Mt. Gox was officially open for business and providing the first widely used exchange services for bitcoin.

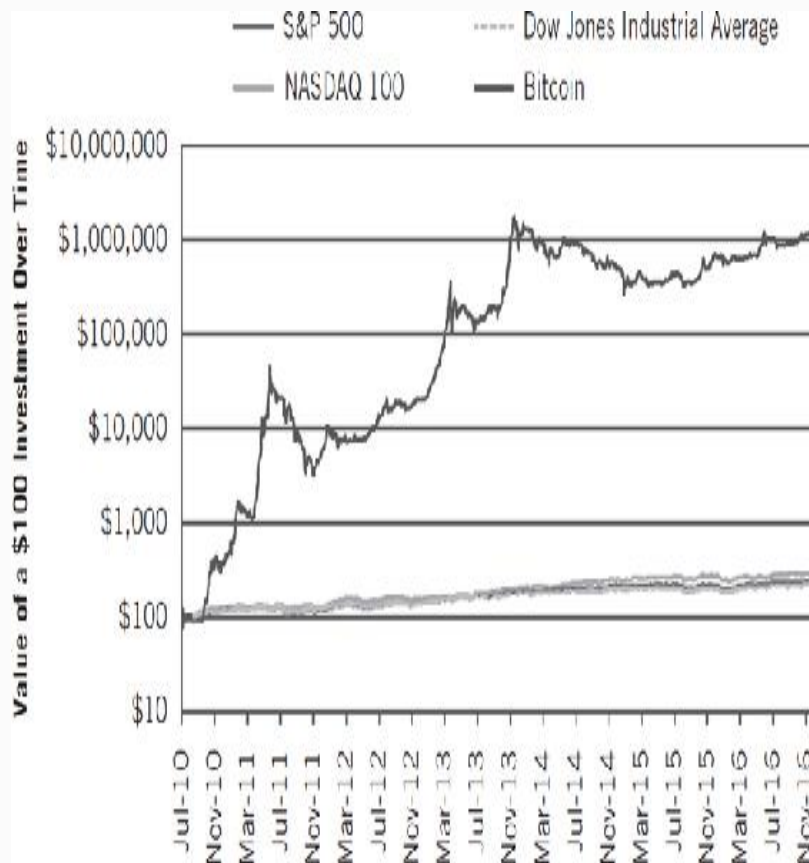


Figure 7.1 ■ Bitcoin's performance compared to major U.S. stock indices since the start of Mt. Gox

Data sourced from Bloomberg and CoinDesks

These broad market indices represent how the stock markets performed on average, with the S&P 500 representing approximately 80 percent coverage of available U.S. equity